Weekly Safety Huddle

Driver Safety Briefing

Week 42
October 12 — October 16, 2026

🛡 SEATBELT USAGE — ZERO EXCEPTIONS

- **Click it every time** — every trip, every seat, no exceptions
- Seatbelts are the #1 defense in a rollover or collision
- DOT citations for unbelted drivers cost **$500+ per offense**
- Set the example — your habits rub off on others
- Buckle up **before** you start moving, not after

> **FACT:** Drivers not wearing seatbelts are 30x more likely to be ejected in a crash. Ejection is almost always fatal.

📞 PHONE & DEVICE RULES — ZERO TOLERANCE

- **No handheld phone use while driving — ZERO tolerance**
- Hands-free mount only for GPS/calls
- No headphones while driving
- Pull over safely if you need to use your device
- Texting while driving = automatic disqualification in most fleets

> **DOT PENALTY:** First offense fine for handheld use is up to $2,750 for drivers, $11,000 for carriers.

⚠ BACKING SAFETY — GOAL

- **GOAL:** Get Out And Look — every single time
- Use a spotter when available — communicate via radio or hand signals
- Check behind BEFORE you get in the truck
- Back slowly — if you can't see, STOP and look
- Use mirrors AND cameras — never rely on just one
- Watch for pedestrians, carts, and other vehicles in your path

> **TIP:** Most backing accidents happen at delivery sites and warehouses — the places you go every day. Stay sharp.

🚨 IF YOU'RE IN AN ACCIDENT — IMMEDIATE STEPS

- **STOP** — Set parking brakes, turn on hazards
- Check for injuries — call 911 if needed
- Protect the scene — warning devices within 10 minutes
- Photos of ALL vehicles, plates, road conditions
- Witness names & phone numbers
- Call dispatch / supervisor immediately

> **Drug Testing:** Mandatory if fatality, OR citation + tow, OR citation + medical treatment away from scene. Alcohol test within 2 hours, drug screen within 32 hours.

☁ ADVERSE WEATHER DRIVING

- **Reduce speed** — 1/3 on wet roads, 1/2+ on snow/ice
- **Increase following distance** to 6-8 seconds
- **Headlights on** anytime visibility is reduced
- **Avoid sudden moves** — no hard braking or sharp turns
- **Black ice** is invisible — bridges and shaded areas freeze first
- If visibility drops below safe levels, **pull over and wait it out**

> **REMEMBER:** You can always replace a delivery. You can't replace a driver.

📦 CARGO SECUREMENT — BEFORE EVERY TRIP

- Check all straps, bars, and tie-downs before driving
- Re-check after 50 miles and at every stop
- Cargo must not shift, fall, or leak onto the road
- Use the right number of tie-downs for the weight
- Cover and secure loose items — nothing flies out
- Know your load weight and distribution

> **DOT VIOLATION:** Unsecured cargo can result in fines, out-of-service orders, and points on your CSA score.

📷 SAMSARA DASH CAMERAS

- Cameras record continuously — assume you're always on camera
- Hard braking, sharp turns, and speeding trigger event recordings
- Keep your dash cam lens clean at all times
- Never obstruct the camera's view
- Events are reviewed by safety team — don't give them reasons
- Good driving = no events = positive reviews

> **TIP:** The camera is your best witness in an accident. It protects YOU when it's not your fault.

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🚶 3 POINTS OF CONTACT — EVERY TIME

- **TWO HANDS, ONE FOOT** OR **TWO FEET, ONE HAND**
- Face the truck when climbing in or out
- **NEVER JUMP** — step down carefully
- Use grab handles — they're there for a reason
- Wet or icy steps? Take extra care — wipe them off
- Carrying something? Set it down and use both hands

> **FACT:** Slip, trip, and fall injuries are the #1 cause of lost-time injuries for truck drivers. Most happen getting in/out of the cab.